

Pedro Gonzalez

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Education: California State University, San Bernardino (CSUSB)

— *B.S. in Computer Science Expected: 2026*

Professional Summary

I am a Tech for Impact computer science student active in my community, helping develop the first framework for automating LLM-based redactions and a community-based smart ridesharing platform placing 3rd in an international innovation challenge. I am a continuous learner and a passionate STEM advocate wanting to empower underrepresented communities.

Research Interests

Passionate about building ethical and impactful technology, advancing Cybersecurity and AI

Research Experience

AI Security Research Intern — *The ACTION NSF Artificial Intelligence Institute, UC Santa Barbara*

June 2025 – August 2025

- Developing **RedactBench**, the first framework for automated LLM-based redactions and synthetic document generation.
 - Presented poster at UC Santa Barbara's 2025 Summer Undergraduate Research Colloquium, reaching 200+ attendees.
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Volunteer Experience

Project Manager — *Ride Splits*

June 2025 – August 2025

- Assisting in onboarding, establishing workflow, and implementing AI chatbot allowing 2nd version to progress
- Innovating a smart commuting social platform aimed at solving transportation infrastructure problems in my community using technology and placing 3rd in Introducing Youth to American infrastructure (IYAI+) international innovation challenge

Developer Intern — *Ride Splits*

March 2025 – May 2025

- Implementing and redesigning additional app screens and features using Adalo to develop a working web app prototype
 - Building a responsive website using HTML and CSS to expand digital presence in a centralized way to access app and other socials
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Fellowships

Emerging Technology, Innovation & Partnerships Fellow — *CSU San Bernardino*

March 2025 – May 2025

- Exploring Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Quantum Computing, Semi-conductors, and Machine Learning through workshops utilizing AI, cloud notebooks like Jupyter and Google Colab as well as other High Performance Computing resources
 - Attending CalSWIFT Symposium hearing key insights from industry leaders in emerging technologies and interdisciplinary fields
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Academic and University Service

Senior Science Buddy — *Science Success Center, CSUSB*

December 2024 – May 2025

- Mentored 15+ STEM students transitioning into university programs; provided academic guidance and campus resources.
- Helped tour over 40+ students in College of Natural Sciences Carnival and set up booth
- Helped coordinate small activity workshop for around 10 students

College of Natural Science Director — *Associated Students Incorporated (ASI), CSUSB*

July 2024 – January 2025

- Represented the college of natural sciences in Board of Directors meetings advocating for students. Regularly holding office hours and meeting students.
- Served on ASI Personnel Committee and Career Center Re-Design Committee.
- Recording video sharing my story and encouraging young legislators to continue to pursue opportunities

Projects

World Travel Game — *Python Terminal Game*

[<https://p-e-d-r-o-gonzalez.itch.io/worldgame>]

- A PROBABILISTIC GAME WITH PRECOMPUTED AI GENERATED EVENTS, RANDOM CHARACTER GENERATION AND RETRO KEY GEN STYLE AESTHETICS

Counting Sheep – Android App – Group Project – Assistant Project Manager

- Gamifies healthy sleep habits: users are able to log their sleep and make goals which on completion they will be rewarded with in-game digital currency which they can use to buy items from the shop. built with unity, firebase, to be released on google play store

HabitGotchi| Android Kotlin App | <https://github.com/ASpoonfulOfSalt/tamagotchi-app> | Quality Assurance

- Testing a gamified productivity app that motivates users to maintain healthy habits through the care of a virtual pet.

California Disadvantaged Communities (DAC) Classifier| Python | Private Repository

- Cleaning original dataset of over 2k communities implementing support vector machine and random forest classifier with approximately 90% accuracy analyzing and visualizing results, due to large number of disadvantaged communities a larger graph was needed

Handwritten Digit Recognizer| Python, Keras | Private Repository

- Using A 70k MNIST Image Dataset For A Deep Learning Convolutional Neural Network (CNN) Resulting In 99% Accuracy Over 10 Epochs, And 200 Batch Size In Handwritten Digit Recognition

Technical Skills

Computational: proficient programming with languages such as Python, Java, HTML, CSS, and R.

Knowledgeable regarding OpenAI API, Synthetic Data Generation, Mimesis, AI Prompt Engineering,

Wireshark, VMware, Rufus, Microsoft Office Suite, Linux, Adalo, Lucidchart, Responsive Web Design, and

Virtual Machines, hashcat, crackStation, cyberChef.

Honors, Awards, & Certifications

- **GIAC Security Essentials (GSEC) 2024**
- **GIAC Foundational Cybersecurity Technologies (GFACT) 2023**
- **National Cyber Scholar** — Top 1000 of 45,962 (2022)
- **Hispanic Scholarship Fund Finalist & Waitlist Scholar** — 2025
- **HACU Scholarship Recipient** — 1 of 20 at CSUSB (2024)
- **AAAI (Academic Applications of AI) Micro-credential** — 2025
- **Seal of Biliteracy in Spanish** — State and District Levels (2022)

Professional AFFILIATIONS & TRAINING

Member | Cyber Intelligence and Security Organization (CISO) | February 2025 – Present

- Competing in National Cyber League (NCL) placing 186th out of 4215 in teams game focusing on password cracking

- Breaking the Matrix Web Exploitation project solving picoCTF challenges, using burp suite and foxyProxy
- Cyber Mentorship Program (CMP) mentee, participating in hands on cyber exercises like OverTheWire, pwn.college, and CTFs

Member | Society for the Advancement of Chicanos/Hispanics and Native Americans in Science (SACNAS) | Dec 2024 – Present • SACNAS SACRED Research Education and Development (RED) circle mentee

Outreach Officer | Computer Science and Engineering (CSE) Club | August 2022 – Present

- CSE Club opener, tabling, working closely with Women in Computer Science and Engineering (WiCSE)

Member | Association for Computing Machinery (ACM) | December 2023 – November 2024

- Staying up to date with cutting edge research and technologies as well as attending talks Member | SANS Institute | September 2023 – Present • Attending AI Cybersecurity Forum, Cyber Solutions Fest, Cloud Security Exchange, and Ransomware Summit

Participant | Jumpstart Into Cyber (JIC) | National Science Foundation (NSF) | 2023-2024

- SEC275: Foundations: Computers, Technology, & Security and SEC401: Security Essentials - Network, Endpoint, and Cloud
- Learning about Linux, Virtual machines, and Cyber Security concepts

Competitor | Cyber Start America and Fast Track | CyberStart | 2022-2024

- Competing in gamified cyber security competition that brings to life real-world hacking challenges and puzzles

Attendee | Caltech Upclose | The California Institute of Technology | 2021

- Prestigious program for students from historically underserved STEM backgrounds, gaining valuable exposure to opportunities.

Languages

- **Spanish:** Native with Seal of Biliteracy (District & State Level, 2022)
- **English:** Fluent